



AP[®]

INCLUDES

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AP[®] Human Geography

COURSE AND EXAM DESCRIPTION

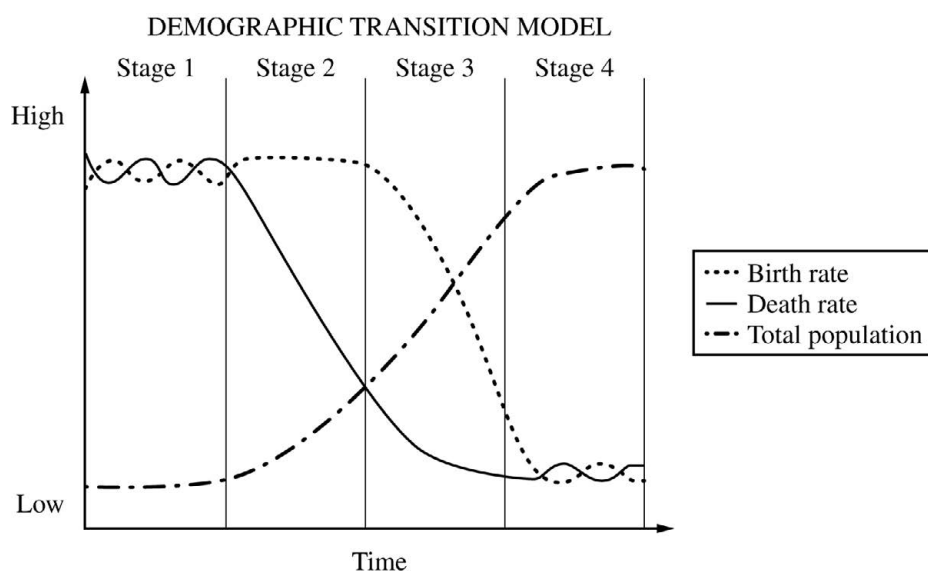
**Effective
Fall 2020**

Sample Exam Questions

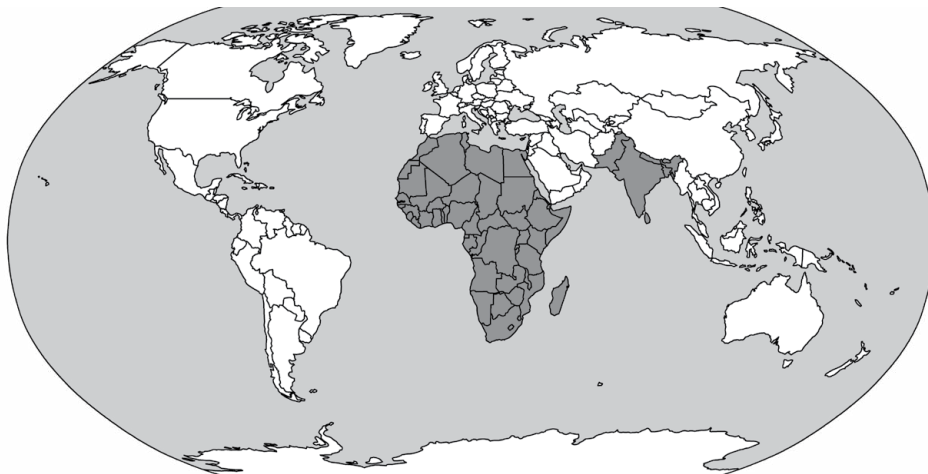
The sample exam questions that follow illustrate the relationship between the course framework and AP Human Geography Exam and serve as examples of the types of questions that appear on the exam. After the sample questions you will find a table that shows which skill, learning objective(s), and unit each question relates to. The table also provides the answers to the multiple-choice questions.

Section I: Multiple-Choice Questions

The following are examples of the kinds of multiple-choice questions found on the exam.



1. Which of the following is a characteristic of a country moving from stage 2 to stage 3 of the demographic transition model?
 - (A) Shorter life expectancy
 - (B) Increasing birth rate
 - (C) High level of female education
 - (D) Declining death rate
 - (E) Increasing dependence on farm labor



2. The Berlin Conference of 1884–1885 and the partition of India in 1947 changed borders in Africa and South Asia and are reflected in the current world map. Which of the following best describes the type of political border resulting from these events?
- (A) Relict boundaries
 - (B) Antecedent boundaries
 - (C) Consequent boundaries
 - (D) Superimposed boundaries
 - (E) Subsequent boundaries

Questions 3–5 refer to the image below.



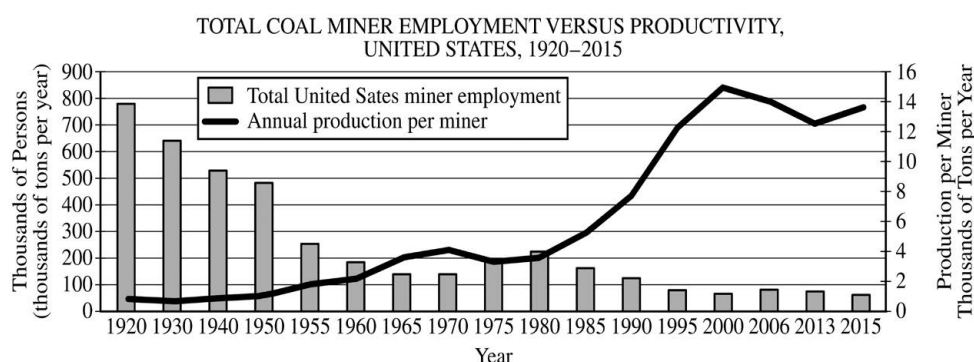
Source: United States Geological Survey

3. Which of the following is the land survey system shown in the satellite image?
 - (A) Multiple nuclei
 - (B) Suburban subdivision
 - (C) Long lots
 - (D) Metes and bounds
 - (E) Township and range

4. In reading the landscape of the image, a geographer will most likely identify the land-survey pattern shown as typical of which of the following locations?
 - (A) A rural agricultural region in the United States
 - (B) An exurb of Paris, France
 - (C) A coastal region of China
 - (D) An agricultural region of eastern Canada
 - (E) A rainforest development in southern Brazil

5. Technologies invented during which of the following periods explain how farmland was divided and cultivated as shown in the satellite image?
- (A) Columbian Exchange, when the use of Old World farm animals such as cows and horses was introduced.
 - (B) First Agricultural Revolution, when the animal-powered plow and domesticated plants were developed.
 - (C) Second Agricultural Revolution, when land-surveying technology and mechanical plows were developed.
 - (D) Modern era, when local farmers used computers and data analysis.
 - (E) Postindustrial era, when local farmers used global positioning systems and geographic information systems.
6. Which of the following factors best explains the development and expansion of squatter settlements?
- (A) Gentrification of megacities in more developed countries displacing large numbers of urban dwellers
 - (B) Rapid urbanization and inability of infrastructure to keep pace with the growth of megacities in developing countries
 - (C) Urban dwellers seeking residential housing and shopping outside the congestion of the city
 - (D) Zoning laws in developing countries that prevent current urban dwellers from obtaining land to build residential structures
 - (E) The growth of urban agriculture encouraging migrant farm workers to move to cities requiring more housing
7. The lush golf courses in the United Arab Emirates, the dikes and polders in the Netherlands, and the Three Gorges Dam in China are significant examples of land use.
- Which of the following viewpoints of human-environment interaction are best described by these land-use examples?
- (A) Environmental determinism
 - (B) Ecotourism
 - (C) Possibilism
 - (D) Heartland theory
 - (E) Malthusian theory

Questions 8 and 9 refer to the following chart.

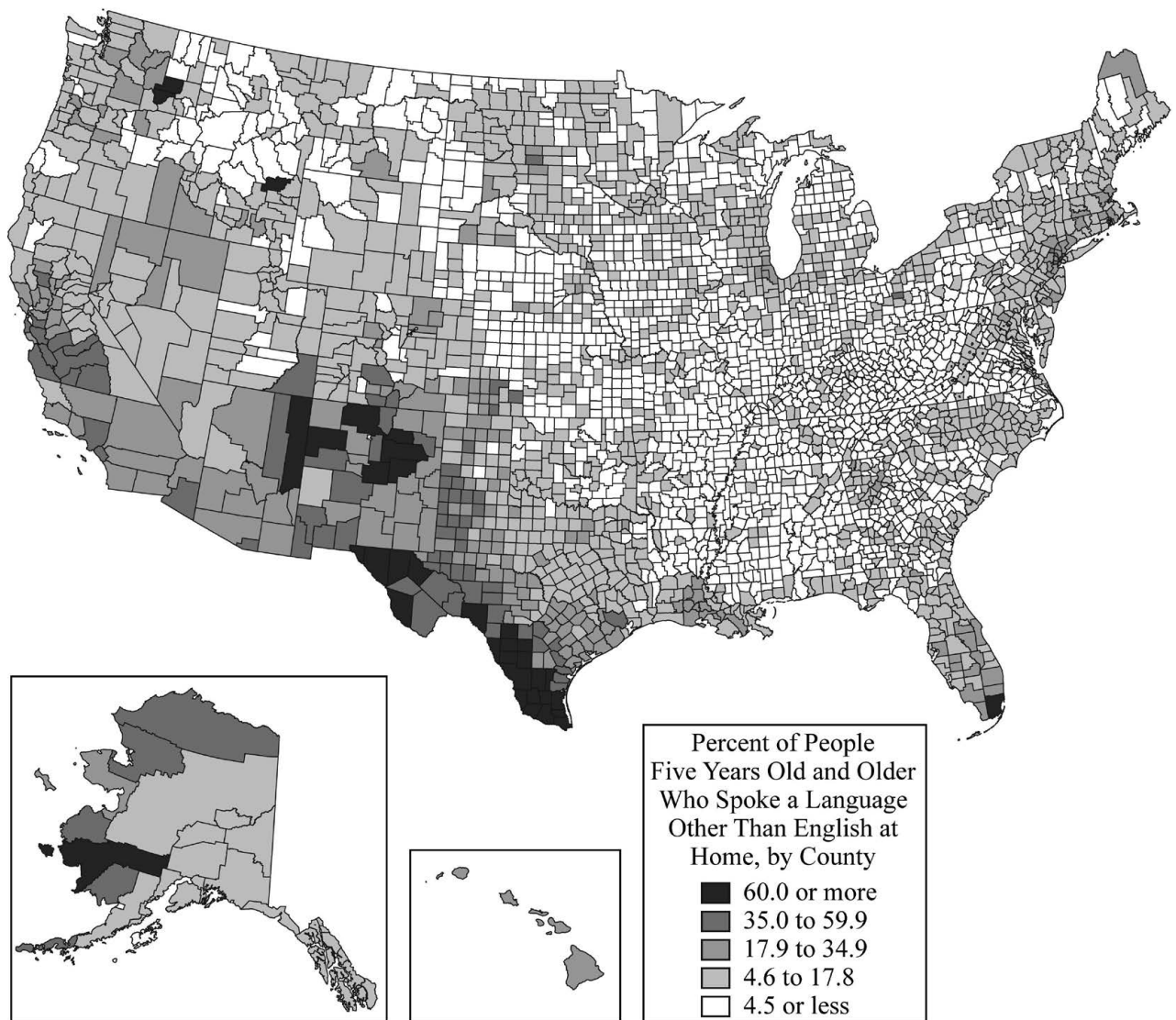


Source: Energy Information Agency

8. Which of the following processes accounts for the change in coal miners employed in the United States from 1950 to 2000?
 - (A) Technological diffusion
 - (B) Just-in-time production
 - (C) Industrial revolution
 - (D) Devolution
 - (E) Deindustrialization

9. Compare the bar graph showing coal mine employment and the line graph showing miner production. Which of the following conclusions can be drawn from trends in this data?
 - (A) Coal mining has been outsourced to less-developed countries.
 - (B) Mechanization and computer automation in mining have increased.
 - (C) Legal restrictions have been imposed on the amount of coal exported overseas.
 - (D) Renewable resources are being used more frequently to power vehicles.
 - (E) Natural gas and oil production of electricity has declined.

10. Which of the following is a pull factor affecting migration to some of the more developed countries?
 - (A) Loss of factory jobs
 - (B) Severe famine
 - (C) The rise of an authoritarian regime
 - (D) Universal health care
 - (E) Religious persecution



Source: United States Census Bureau

11. Based on the map, which of the following languages are most likely to be spoken in counties where 60 percent or more of residents spoke a language other than English at home?
- (A) French and French Creole languages
 - (B) Spanish and American Indian languages
 - (C) German and Dutch
 - (D) Russian and Hindi
 - (E) Chinese and Arabic

12. Which of the following best explains a neo-Malthusian perspective on the Green Revolution?
- (A) The Green Revolution represents a jump in agricultural technology, but population will still grow faster than our ability to produce food will over the long run.
 - (B) The Green Revolution solves the entire problem of feeding the planet, and Malthusian ideas are no longer relevant.
 - (C) Local food production is the key to long-term food production.
 - (D) The distribution of food in a capitalist system results in too many people being unable to afford basic foods.
 - (E) The increase in the food supply and a resulting increase in the population available for farm labor will solve the food crisis.

TOP FIVE URBANIZED AREAS: CHINA AND THE UNITED STATES

China	Population
Shanghai	25.6 million
Beijing	19.6 million
Chongqing	14.8 million
Tianjin	13.2 million
Guangzhou	12.6 million

United States	Population
New York City	18.8 million
Los Angeles	12.5 million
Chicago	8.9 million
Houston	6.1 million
Dallas-Fort Worth	6.1 million

Source: The United Nations *The World's Cities in 2018: Data Booklet*

13. Compare the largest municipality populations for each country, and then select the following statement that correctly draws a conclusion regarding the pattern in the data.
- (A) China has a primate city, and the United States follows the rank-size rule.
 - (B) Both countries follow the rank-size rule.
 - (C) Neither country follows the rank-size rule.
 - (D) Both countries have a primate city.
 - (E) The United States has a primate city, and China follows the rank-size rule.

14. Which of the following correctly pairs a global religion described with its hearth region of origin?
- (A) Buddhism and East Asia
 - (B) Christianity and Latin America
 - (C) Islam and Central Asia
 - (D) Hinduism and South Asia
 - (E) Judaism and eastern Europe
15. The United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea sets the limit of the exclusive economic zone at 200 nautical miles from a country's coastline. In cases where countries are less than 400 nautical miles apart at sea, which of the following explains how the exclusive economic zone boundary is determined for each country?
- (A) Both countries will state their case to the United Nations during a hearing of the Security Council.
 - (B) Both countries will follow the median-line principle.
 - (C) Both countries will share all of the water area.
 - (D) Neither country can claim the area as an exclusive economic zone because the area is considered international water.
 - (E) Both countries will receive increased territorial sea claims up to 24 nautical miles but will have no exclusive economic zone.

Section II: Free-Response Questions

The following are examples of the kinds of free-response questions found on the exam. Note that on the actual AP Exam, there will be three free-response questions.

Free-Response Question—no stimulus (Question 1 on AP Exam)

In most countries, the concept of the state as a political unit is subject to the tensions between centrifugal and centripetal forces. Governments are often challenged by the devolutionary factors that challenge state sovereignty.

- (A) Define the concept of the multinational state.
- (B) Explain how ethnicity can be a factor that leads to the devolution of a state.
- (C) Explain how communication technology plays an important role in the goals of devolutionary groups and democracy movements.
- (D) Explain the limitations of communication technology in furthering the goals of devolutionary groups and democracy movements.
- (E) Describe ONE centripetal force that governments use to promote the state as a nation.
- (F) Explain how uneven development within a state can act as a centrifugal force.
- (G) For a multinational state facing the realities of devolution, explain why a government would choose to create an autonomous region or choose to maintain a unitary state.

Free-Response Question—two stimuli (Question 3 on AP Exam)

NATIONAL CAPITAL TERRITORY OF DELHI, INDIA, POPULATION CHANGE

Census Year	1991	2001	2011
Total population	9,420,644	13,850,507	16,787,941
Population density per square mile	17,771	26,128	31,669

COMMUTERS IN DELHI, INDIA



Source: Getty Images / Hindustan Times

(See Free-response question 3 on next page.)

The National Capital Territory of Delhi, India, includes the old city of Delhi; the national capital city of New Delhi; and surrounding districts, where much of the city's population resides.

- (A) Describe the data in the table that classifies Delhi as a megacity.
- (B) Describe a pull factor that has contributed to Delhi's total population change over time.
- (C) Explain how local housing development has contributed to the change in Delhi's population density, as shown in the data table.
- (D) Given Delhi's population density, describe a challenge related to urban infrastructure that the city's government is likely to face.
- (E) Explain the challenge to Delhi's local environmental sustainability that is shown in the photograph.
- (F) Explain the degree to which India's level of economic development as a country contributes to Delhi's local challenges to environmental sustainability.
- (G) Explain a possible solution to the challenge of environmental sustainability that is shown in the photograph.

Answer Key and Question Alignment to Course Framework

Multiple-Choice Question	Answer	Skill	Learning Objective	Unit
1	D	1.A	IMP-2.B	2
2	D	4.B	IMP-4.A	4
3	E	4.A	PSO-5.B	5
4	A	4.A	PSO-5.B	5
5	C	4.E	SPS-5.C	5
6	B	2.C	SPS-6.A	6
7	C	1.D	PSO-1.B	1
8	E	3.B	PSO-7.A	7
9	B	3.D	PSO-7.A	7
10	D	2.A	IMP-2.C	2
11	B	3.A	PSO-3.D	3
12	A	2.C	SPS-5.D	5
13	C	3.D	PSO-6.C	6
14	D	1.D	IMP-3.B	3
15	B	2.C	IMP-4.B	4

Free-Response Question	Question Type	Skill	Learning Objective	Unit
1	No stimulus	1.A, 1.B, 1.E, 2.A, 2.C, 5.B	PSO-4.A, SPS-4.A, SPS-4.B, SPS-4.C, SPS-7.B	5
2	Two stimuli	1.D, 2.A, 2.C, 3.B, 3.C, 4.E, 5.D	PSO-6.A, IMP-2.C, IMP-6.A, IMP-6.B, IMP-6.D, SPS-6.B	6

The scoring information for the questions within this course and exam description, along with further exam resources, can be found on the [AP Human Geography Exam Page](#) on AP Central.



Scoring Guidelines

Question 1: No stimulus

In most countries, the concept of the state as a political unit is subject to the tensions between centrifugal and centripetal forces. Governments are often challenged by the devolutionary factors that challenge state sovereignty.

- (A) Define the concept of the multinational state.
- (B) Explain how ethnicity can be a factor that leads to the devolution of a state.
- (C) Explain how communication technology plays an important role in the goals of devolutionary groups and democracy movements.
- (D) Explain the limitations of communication technology in furthering the goals of devolutionary groups and democracy movements.
- (E) Describe ONE centripetal force that governments use to promote the state as a nation.
- (F) Explain how uneven development within a state can act as a centrifugal force.
- (G) For a multinational state facing the realities of devolution, explain why a government would choose to create an autonomous region or choose to maintain a unitary state.

Scoring Guidelines for Question 1: No stimulus

7 points

Learning Objectives: PSO-4.A SPS-4.A SPS-4.B SPS-4.C SPS-7.B

- (A)** Define the concept of the multinational state. **1 point**
1.A
- A country with multiple culture groups or multiple ethnic groups under a single government.
-
- (B)** Explain how ethnicity can be a factor that leads to the devolution of a state. **1 point**
1.B
- Accept one of the following:
- Ethnic differences, ethnocentrism, or ethnic separatism can be the source of conflict between culture groups, or between one ethnic group and a government.
 - One or more ethnic groups may control a government, while another ethnic group has limited political power.
 - Ethnic nationalist political parties may compete for political power or attempt to gain control of territory.
 - An ethnic group existing within a territory shared with other culture groups may attempt to gain control through armed conflict, ethnic cleansing, or terrorism
 - Irredentism, as a country may attempt to annex or regain territory in a neighboring state inhabited by people who have ethnic ties back that country.
 - An ethnic group may desire to establish its own nation-state or agree to establish an autonomous region within an existing country.
-
- (C)** Explain how communication technology plays an important role in the goals of devolutionary groups and democracy movements. **1 point**
1.B
- Accept one of the following:
- Personal computers, personal communication devices, or cell phones can be used to connect people who support a common ethnic, religious, or political desire to devolve the state or reform the government.
 - Software applications (apps) for social networking can be used to connect people who support a common ethnic, religious, or political desire to devolve the state or reform the government.
 - Radio, television, news, or the internet can be used to broadcast ethnic, religious, or political groups intent to devolve the state or reform the government.
 - Ethnic, religious, or political groups who intend to devolve the state or reform the government can develop their own apps, websites, channels or news.
-
- (D)** Explain the limitations of communication technology in furthering the goals of devolutionary groups and democracy movements. **1 point**
1.E
- Accept one of the following:
- Governments can shut down cellular phone towers, data networks, or satellite uplinks to prevent social networking
 - Governments can filter or block information entering their country via the Internet or on social network sites.
 - Governments can ban media from broadcasting information, news, websites or other media regarding an ethnic, religious, or political groups who intend to devolve the state or reform the government.
 - Governments can counter devolutionary groups and democracy movements with pro-government applications, information, news or media.
 - Governments can use surveillance software, electronic warfare, or counterespionage (spy) techniques to hack or destroy the networks run by devolutionary groups and democracy movements.

- (E)** Describe ONE centripetal force that governments use to promote the state as a nation. **1 point**
2.A
- Governments may promote a political nationalism, ethnic nationalism, or patriotism, through forms of identity, such as symbols, folklore, sports, holidays, military or other traditions.
-

- (F)** Explain how uneven development within a state can act as a centrifugal force. **1 point**
2.C
- Accept one of the following:
- When a part of a country is neglected economically by a government, resentful local residents may attempt to gain local or regional political control.
 - Countries with primate cities can have a highly-developed city or capital while the rest of the country is relatively underdeveloped; this can create devolutionary pressures.
-

- (G)** For a multinational state facing the realities of devolution, explain why a government would choose to create an autonomous region or choose to maintain a unitary state. **1 point**
5.B
- Accept one of the following:
- The creation of an autonomous region would give an ethnic group limited self-determination, but this may weaken the state's control over the region's territory, people, and resources.
 - Maintaining a unitary state would give the government full control over territory, people, and resources, but this risks rebellion against the state by the region's ethnic group.
-

Total for question 1 7 points

Question 3: Two stimuli

NATIONAL CAPITAL TERRITORY OF DELHI, INDIA, POPULATION CHANGE

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COMMUTERS IN DELHI, INDIA



Source: Getty Images / Hindustan Times

(See question 3 on next page.)

The National Capital Territory of Delhi, India, includes the old city of Delhi; the national capital city of New Delhi; and surrounding districts, where much of the city's population resides.

- (A) Describe the data in the table that classifies Delhi as a megacity.
- (B) Describe a pull factor that has contributed to Delhi's total population change over time.
- (C) Explain how local housing development has contributed to the change in Delhi's population density, as shown in the data table.
- (D) Given Delhi's population density, describe a challenge related to urban infrastructure that the city's government is likely to face.
- (E) Explain the challenge to Delhi's local environmental sustainability that is shown in the photograph.
- (F) Explain the degree to which India's level of economic development as a country contributes to Delhi's local challenges to environmental sustainability.
- (G) Explain a possible solution to the challenge of environmental sustainability that is shown in the photograph.

Scoring Guidelines for Question 3: Two stimuli

7 points

Learning Objectives: PSO-6.A IMP-2.C IMP-6.A IMP6.B IMP-6.D SPS-6.B

- (A)** Describe the data in the table that classifies Delhi as a megacity. **1 point**
Accept one of the following: **3.B**
- Delhi is classified as a megacity because it has a total population greater than 10 million.
 - From 1991 to 2011, Delhi's total population grew to over 10 million.
-
- (B)** Describe a pull factor that has contributed to Delhi's total population change over time. **1 point**
Many people move to Delhi from rural areas and smaller cities.... **2.A**
AND
One of the following reasons:
- in search of employment opportunities
 - in the hopes of improving their income or quality of life
 - to join family members or friends already living in Delhi
 - to have better access to services, health care, or education
-
- (C)** Explain how local housing development has contributed to the change in Delhi's population density, as shown in the data table. **1 point**
Accept one of the following: **3.C**
- The city's center increases in the size, height, and/or number of large apartment buildings and condominium that attract a growing population of middle-class workers in the country's capital
 - Infilling occurs where open space presents an economic opportunity for landowners to build small multi-family housing units, placing more people into existing city blocks
 - The government is increasing its provision of public housing in apartment blocks within the city, which provide larger buildings with multi-family housing units.
-
- (D)** Given Delhi's population density, describe a challenge related to urban infrastructure that the city's government is likely to face. **1 point**
Accept one of the following: **1.D**
- A need for additional public transportation lines and/or added capacity on existing transit systems
 - A need for improved sanitation, water supply, waste disposal, or wastewater treatment facilities
 - A need for more housing, especially for lower-income residents
 - A need for improved communication or electric utility infrastructure
 - A need for additional public schools, colleges, universities, and/or libraries.
-

- (E)** Explain a challenge to Delhi's local environmental sustainability that is shown in the photograph. **1 point**
Increased number of vehicles on the roadways results in visible air pollution, fog, smog, and/or airborne chemicals that lead to.... **4.E**
- AND
- One of the following:
- health problems
 - transportation accidents
 - diverting potential economic investment in the city
-
- (F)** Explain the degree to which India's level of economic development as a country contributes to Delhi's local challenges to environmental sustainability. **1 point**
Accept one of the following: **5.D**
- India is a less developed country which has limited government funding to pay for pollution abatement programs (such as alternative fuels) or large investments in public transit.
 - India has a growing industrial sector which has limited environmental regulations such as controls on air pollution. Industrial air emissions contribute to the city's air pollution levels.
 - India has a large rural population and urban poor population who are dependent on burning wood for home heating and cooking. The smoke increases the city's air pollution levels.
 - During the dry season, farmers in northern India will burn the dead vegetation in their fields (following the harvest) to improve soil nutrients. The smoke can increase the city's air pollution levels.
 - As India's economy grows, more people can afford to own cars or buy trucks for their businesses. The additional vehicle increases the total amount of air pollution.
-
- (G)** Explain a possible solution to the challenge of environmental sustainability that is shown in the photograph. **1 point**
Accept one of the following: **2.C**
- Transportation-oriented development of new housing, industrial and retailing areas. Or, laws requiring new developments be constructed with bus lanes, train lines, and stations.
 - Vehicle restrictions, high-occupancy requirements, tolls, or congestion pricing to limit the number of vehicles on the roads.
 - Smart-growth policies, slow-growth, or zoning policies that restrict the amount of land that can be developed or create a development boundary or greenbelt around the city.
 - Alternative electrical energy and/or alternative fuel programs that are cleaner-burning or have zero emissions.
 - New Urbanism or mixed land-use developments where workers live, shop, and work within walkable distances.
-

Total for question 3 7 points